Admin OS: From Reporting Surface to Operating System

Bonusly - workshop pre-read - carlosluis duchicela - feb 2026

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- Feb 2026

Workshop Pre-Read

Why This Session Exists

The Admin Dashboard today surfaces strong signals: participation, program adoption, and cost. It provides visibility.

The question we want to explore together is:

What is the primary job of this dashboard?

Is it primarily a reporting surface? Or should it function as an operating system for admins?

Reporting answers:

How are things?

Operating answers:

What should I do next?

Which lever matters most right now?

If I act, what outcome should I expect?

Are we safe from a governance perspective?

If we believe the job is operating, then sequencing, prioritization, and decision scaffolding may matter more than layout changes.

This session is about aligning on that job definition before debating solutions.

Current State: Behavioral Observations

Participation & Frequency

What works:

Clear pulse metrics

Fast visibility

Evaluative labels (Great / Average / Low)

Potential friction:

Snapshot without interpretation

Labels not directly tied to action

No expectation-setting around time-to-impact

Open question: When an admin sees Average, what is the intended next step?

Behavioral hypothesis: Admins may interpret manually, open support tickets, or leave without action.

Program Adoption

What works:

Clear program inventory

Transparent configuration

Potential friction:

Programs presented as inventory rather than levers

No explicit goal-relative prioritization

No signal of which program matters most right now

Open question: Do admins know which lever to pull when participation dips, or is that typically prescribed externally (e.g., by CSMs)?

Behavioral hypothesis: We may be encouraging maintenance behavior rather than strategic behavior.

Cost Breakdown

What works:

Transparent reporting

Finance-ready visibility

Potential friction:

Surfaces cost exposure without structured governance guidance

No clear safe intervention path

No expectation-setting around variance

Open question: When finance raises a cost concern, what path does the admin follow?

Behavioral hypothesis: We may be creating reactive cost behavior rather than guided cost governance.

Working Synthesis

Across participation, programs, and cost, we may have:

Strong signal visibility

Limited prioritization guidance

Limited decision scaffolding

No explicit action ? outcome loop

This likely impacts onboarding most clearly, but may also affect mature admins who use the dashboard episodically.

Hypotheses We Want to Pressure Test

These are not conclusions - they are starting points for discussion.

The dashboard should support an explicit operating loop:

Orient ? Decide ? Act ? Learn

Today, we may primarily support Orient.

Admin usage is episodic.

If so, each visit may need:

Entropy reduction

Clear prioritization

Obvious next action

Programs should behave like levers.

Instead of inventory visibility, the system might:

Tie programs to goals

Highlight one focus

Offer a limited set of recommended actions

Cost should behave like governance.

That may mean: status ? explanation ? safe intervention

AI's role (if any) should likely be orchestration:

Ranking what matters

Explaining why

Prefilling actions

Summarizing outcomes

What We Need From This Session

Alignment on:

Is the core problem correctly framed?

Should the dashboard primarily operate, not just report?

Is guided prioritization the right initial wedge?

Which admin triggers matter most?

How disciplined should we be about phased validation?

What does success look like from a leading and lagging perspective?

The prototype will be presented as a working hypothesis to pressure test against this framing.

Docs:

proto:
https://www.figma.com/make/SIFvJknqZ6bKdBq4tjrxT3/duchicela---bonusly-admin-OS?t=1aFlsxWQI1BD0B7Y-

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board:
https://www.figma.com/board/RtKhYfrRDpFeQoLOKtoPpS/bonusly-brainstorm?node-id=0-1&t=822CtvJqma1qp0aU-1

one-pager:
https://docs.google.com/document/d/1SsfpPr7vnx3MDFBC4VTd2wA9OJYhJHvDb8rZh12Fv60/edit?usp=sharing